

Arrested Development

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(Redirected from [Arrested Development \(TV series\)](#))

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Arrested Development is an American [satirical](#) television [sitcom](#) created by [Mitchell Hurwitz](#) that debuted on [Fox](#) on November 2, 2003. It follows the Bluth family, a formerly wealthy, [dysfunctional family](#) and is presented in a [serialized format](#), incorporating handheld camera work, [voice-over](#) narration, archival photos and historical footage, and maintains numerous [running gags](#) and [catchphrases](#). [Ron Howard](#) served as both an executive producer and the [omniscient narrator](#) and, in later seasons, appears in the show as a fictionalized version of himself. Set in [Newport Beach, California](#), the series was filmed primarily in [Culver City](#) and [Marina del Rey](#).^[4]

Arrested Development received critical acclaim. It won six [Primetime Emmy Awards](#) and a [Golden Globe Award](#), and attracted a [cult following](#).^[5] It has been widely regarded as one of the greatest TV shows of all time.^{[6][7][8][9][10]} It influenced later [single-camera](#) comedy series such as *[30 Rock](#)* and *[Community](#)*.^[11]

Despite the positive critical response, *Arrested Development* received low ratings on Fox, which canceled the series in 2006. In 2011, [Netflix](#) licensed new episodes and distributed them on its [streaming service](#).^[12] These episodes were released in May 2013, and was among the first of Netflix's original programming.^[13] Netflix commissioned a fifth season of *Arrested Development*, the first half of which premiered in May 2018, and the second half in March 2019.^{[14][15][16]}

Arrested Development



Genre	Sitcom Absurdist humor^[1] Black comedy^[1] Comedy verite^[2] Cringe comedy^[3]
Created by	Mitchell Hurwitz
Showrunner	Mitchell Hurwitz
Starring	Jason Bateman Portia de Rossi Will Arnett Michael Cera Alia Shawkat Tony Hale David Cross Jeffrey Tambor Jessica Walter
Narrated by	Ron Howard
Music by	David Schwartz
Country of origin	United States
Original language	English
No. of seasons	5
No. of episodes	84 (list of episodes)
Production	

Production [edit]

Conception [edit]

Discussion that led to the creation of the series began in the summer of 2002. [Ron Howard](#) had the original idea to create a [comedy series](#) in the style of handheld cameras and reality television, but with an elaborate, highly comical script resulting from repeated rewritings and rehearsals. Howard met with [David Nevins](#), the president of [Imagine Television](#), Katie O'Connell, a senior vice president, and two writers, including [Mitchell Hurwitz](#). In light of recent [corporate accounting scandals](#), such as [Enron](#) and [Adelphia](#), Hurwitz suggested a story about a "riches to rags" family. Howard and Imagine were interested in using this idea, and signed Hurwitz to write the show. The idea was pitched and sold in Q3 2002. There was a bidding war for the show between Fox and NBC, with the show ultimately selling to Fox as a [put pilot](#) with a six-figure penalty.^[17]

Over the next few months, Hurwitz developed the characters and plot for the series. The script of the [pilot episode](#) was submitted in January 2003 and filmed in March 2003. It was submitted in late April to [Fox](#) and was added to the network's fall schedule that May.^[18]

Casting [edit]

Main article: [List of Arrested Development cast members](#)

[Alia Shawkat](#) was the first cast in the series.^[18] [Michael Cera](#), [Tony Hale](#), and [Jessica Walter](#) were cast from video tapes and flown in to audition for Fox.^[18] [Jason Bateman](#) and [Portia de Rossi](#) both read and auditioned for the network and were immediately chosen.^[18] The character of Gob was the most challenging to cast, but when [Will Arnett](#)'s audition played the character "like a guy who thought of himself as the chosen son, even though it was obvious to everyone else that he was the least favorite," he was chosen immediately for his portrayal.^[19] The characters of Tobias and George Sr. were originally going to have minor roles, but [David Cross](#) and [Jeffrey Tambor](#)'s portrayals mixed well with the rest of the characters, and they were given more significant parts.^[18] Howard provided the narration for the initial pilot, and his narrating meshed so well with the tone of the program that the decision was made to keep his voice.^[20] Howard aided in the casting of "Lucille 2"; the producers told him that their dream actress for the role was [Liza Minnelli](#) but that they assumed no one of her stature would take the part.^[21] She agreed when Ron Howard asked her himself, because they were old friends; she had been his babysitter when she was a teenager.^[22]

Executive producers	Brian Grazer Ron HowardDavid NevinsMitchell HurwitzJim VallelyTroy Miller
Producers	Victor HsuBarbie Feldman AdlerBrad CopelandJohn AmodeoJohn FoyJoe RussoAnthony RussoMichael Cera
Camera setup	Single-camera
Running time	22 minutes (seasons 1–3) 23–48 minutes (seasons 4–5)
Production companies	Imagine TelevisionThe Hurwitz Company20th Century Fox Television
Original release	
Network	Fox
Release	November 2, 2003 – February 10, 2006
Network	Netflix
Release	May 26, 2013 – March 15, 2019

Filming techniques [[edit](#)]

Arrested Development uses several elements that were rare at the time for American live-action sitcoms. It was shot on location and in HD video (at 24 frames per second) with multiple cameras, parodying tactics often employed in documentary film and reality television, straying from the "fixed-set, [studio audience](#), [laugh track](#)" style long dominant in comedy production.^[23] The show makes heavy use of [cutaway gags](#), supplementing the narrative with visual punchlines like security camera footage, Bluth family photos, website screenshots, archive films, and flashbacks.^[23] An omniscient third-person narrator (producer Ron Howard) ties together the multiple plot threads running through each episode, while humorously undercutting and commenting on the characters.^[24] *Arrested Development* developed [self-referentiality](#) through use of [in-jokes](#) that evolved over multiple episodes, which rewarded longtime viewership (and in turn may have discouraged new viewers and contributed to the show's ratings difficulties).^[23]

Because of scheduling conflicts,^{[25][26]} the fourth season used a different format with longer episodes focusing on one character.^{[27][28]} The season was later re-edited to be more in line with the format of the other seasons.^{[28][29]}

Cancellation and revival [[edit](#)]

During the series' [third season](#) in 2006, despite months-long rumors of *Arrested Development* having been picked up by the cable television network [Showtime](#),^[30] creator Hurwitz declined to move the show to another network.^[31] Hurwitz said, "I had taken it as far as I felt I could as a series. I told the story I wanted to tell, and we were getting to a point where I think a lot of the actors were ready to move on."^[32] He said that he was "more worried about letting down the fans in terms of the quality of the show dropping" than he was about disappointing fans by not giving them more episodes. He also said, "If there's a way to continue this in a form that's not weekly episodic series television, I'd be up for it".



The cast does the "chicken dance" at the *Arrested Development* reunion on October 2, 2011.

After the series cancellation, Fox Entertainment Group sold the initial 53-episode run for syndication. In a first for its kind, the syndication involved a three-year deal with [Microsoft](#)'s nascent internet video streaming service [MSN Video](#) (now Bing Video) before the series would go on to cable channel [G4](#).^[33]

On October 2, 2011, the cast of *Arrested Development* reunited for a panel at [The New Yorker Festival](#) in New York.^{[34][35]} At the panel, Hurwitz declared his intention of producing a truncated fourth season as a lead-in to a film adaptation.^[36]

Six years after the series had been canceled by Fox, filming for a [fourth season](#) began on August 7, 2012.^[37] Fifteen episodes of the show's revival season were released simultaneously on [Netflix](#) on May 26, 2013.^[13] Although it received generally favorable reviews,^[38] it was far less well-received than prior

seasons, leading Netflix to re-edit the season in 2018.^[27] Netflix confirmed on May 17, 2017,^[39] that a [fifth season](#) was expected to be released on its service in 2018, with filming taking place from August 2017 to November 2017.^{[40][41]} *Arrested Development* was set to be removed from Netflix on March 15, 2023.^[42] However, after a last-minute deal, Netflix retained the streaming rights.^[43]

Characters [\[edit \]](#)

Main characters [\[edit \]](#)

Main article: [List of Arrested Development characters](#)

The plot of *Arrested Development* revolves around the members of the Bluth family, a formerly wealthy family who continue to lead extravagant lifestyles despite their changed circumstances.^{[44][45]} At the center of the show is [Michael Bluth](#) ([Jason Bateman](#)), the show's [straight man](#), who strives to do the right thing and keep his family together, despite their materialism, selfishness, and manipulative natures.^[44] Michael is a widowed single father.^[46] His teenage son, [George Michael](#) ([Michael Cera](#)), has the same qualities of decency but feels a constant pressure to live up to his father's expectations and is often reluctant to follow his father's plans. He battles with a crush he has on cousin [Mae "Maeby" Fünke](#) ([Alia Shawkat](#)), which developed from a kiss she gave him as part of a prank.^[44]



From left to right: Gob, George Sr., Lindsay, Tobias, Michael, Lucille, George Michael, Maeby, and Buster

Michael's father, [George Bluth Sr.](#) ([Jeffrey Tambor](#)), is the patriarch of the family and a corrupt real estate developer who is arrested in the first episode. George goes to considerable lengths to manipulate and control his family in spite of his imprisonment, and makes numerous efforts to evade justice.^[47] His wife, and Michael's mother, [Lucille](#) ([Jessica Walter](#)), is ruthlessly manipulative, materialistic, constantly drunk, and hypercritical of every member of her family.^[44] Her grip is tightest on her youngest son, [Byron "Buster" Bluth](#) ([Tony Hale](#)), who is overeducated on various random subjects but lacks emotional intelligence or common sense. Buster is also a [mother's boy](#) with dependency issues and is prone to [panic attacks](#).^[44]

Michael's older brother is [George Oscar Bluth II](#) ([Will Arnett](#)), known by his initials GOB, which is pronounced in the series like the Biblical figure Job (/dʒoʊb/).^[44] An unsuccessful professional magician whose business and personal schemes usually fail or become tiresome and are quickly abandoned, Gob is competitive with Michael and bullies Buster.^[44] Michael's twin sister, [Lindsay](#) ([Portia de Rossi](#)), is spoiled and materialistic, continually seeking to be the center of attention and espousing various social causes for the sake of vanity.^[48] In the finale, it is revealed that she and Lucille are half-sisters.^[49] She is married to [Tobias Fünke](#) ([David Cross](#)), a discredited psychiatrist-turned-aspiring actor.^[44] Tobias is a self-diagnosed "never-nude" (a disorder comparable to [gymnophobia](#)), whose language and behavior have heavily homosexual overtones to which he seems oblivious and which are the center of much tongue-in-cheek comedy throughout the series.^{[48][50]} Their daughter, Maeby, is a rebellious teen with an opportunistic streak,

who seeks to defy her parents for the sake of attention, and otherwise pursues boys and power, and furthers her complicated relationship with George Michael.^[44]

Recurring cast [[edit](#)]

Numerous other characters appear in recurring roles.^[51]

- [Jeffrey Tambor](#) as [Oscar Bluth](#), George Sr.'s identical twin brother, a lethargic ex-hippie seeking the affection of Lucille.^[52]
- [Henry Winkler](#) as [Barry Zuckerkorn](#), the family's lawyer, an incompetent sexual deviant who often hinders the family's legal battles rather than helping them.^[50] He is eventually replaced by Bob Loblaw ([Scott Baio](#)).^[51] (The actor's son [Max Winkler](#) portrays Barry in flashbacks)
- [Liza Minnelli](#) as [Lucille Austero](#), AKA "Lucille 2", Lucille's "best friend and chief social rival" as well as a sometimes-love-interest of Buster and Gob.^[53] The character was killed off in the fifth season.^[54]
- Justin Grant Wade as Steve Holt, a high school [super-senior](#) and football star at the high school George Michael and Maeby attend, and later discovered to be Gob's son.^[55]
- [Carl Weathers](#) as a fictional parody of [himself](#), Tobias's frugal acting coach.^[56]
- [John Beard](#) as a fictional version of [himself](#), a news anchor reporting on the characters' antics.^[57]
- [Mae Whitman](#) as [Ann Veal](#), George-Michael's stern Christian girlfriend, often forgotten or disparaged by Michael.^[53] (Ann was first played by [Alessandra Torresani](#).)
- [Patricia Velasquez](#) as [Marta Estrella](#), Gob's girlfriend who eventually reciprocates Michael's infatuation with her and ends up causing conflict between the two brothers. (Marta was first played by [Leonor Varela](#))^[58]
- [Steve Ryan](#) as [J. Walter Weatherman](#), a former employee of George Sr. who appears in flashbacks, in which he helps teach lessons to George Sr's children, by participating in staged accidents where he would "lose" his (prosthetic) arm.^[53]
- [Charlize Theron](#) as [Rita Leeds](#), an intellectually disabled British woman whom Michael becomes infatuated with, not recognizing her disability.^[59]
- [Dave Thomas](#) as Trevor
- [Judy Greer](#) as [Kitty Sanchez](#), George Sr's manipulative assistant, lover, and partner-in-crime.^[60]
- [Ed Begley Jr.](#) as [Stan Sitwell](#), the owner of Sitwell Enterprises, a rival company to the Bluth Company.^[61]
- [Christine Taylor](#) as [Sally Sitwell](#), Stan Sitwell's daughter and a long-standing love interest for Michael.^[62]
- [Justin Lee](#) as [Annyong](#), the adopted Korean son of Lucille and George Sr.^[63]
- [Julia Louis-Dreyfus](#) as [Maggie Lizer](#), an attorney and compulsive liar who has a recurring relationship with Michael.^[64]



[Henry Winkler](#) portrays incompetent lawyer Barry Zuckerkorn.

- Rob Corddry** as **Moses Taylor**, the star of the fictional TV show *Wrench!* and a noted gun rights activist.^[65]
- Ben Stiller** as **Tony Wonder**, a magician and Gob's chief rival, well known for baking himself into a loaf of bread to feed the troops.^[66]
- Amy Poehler** as **Gob's unnamed and frequently forgotten wife**, who married Gob as the final in a long line of escalating dares.^[67]
- Jane Lynch** as **Cindi Lightballoon**, a government mole who tries to gather incriminating information from an incarcerated George Sr. but ends up falling in love with him instead.^[68]
- Ron Howard** as a **fictionalized version of himself**, a movie producer who offers to adapt the Bluths' lives into a movie.^[69]
- Isla Fisher** as **Rebel Alley**, Ron Howard's fictional daughter and love interest of both Michael and George Michael.^[70]

Episodes [[edit](#)]

Main article: [List of Arrested Development episodes](#)

Season		Episodes		Originally released		
				First released	Last released	Network
	1	22		November 2, 2003	June 6, 2004	Fox
	2	18		November 7, 2004	April 17, 2005	
	3	13		September 19, 2005	February 10, 2006	
	4	37 ^[a]	15	May 26, 2013		Netflix
			22	May 4, 2018		
	5	16	8	May 29, 2018		
			8	March 15, 2019		

Season 1 (2003–04) [[edit](#)]

Main article: [Arrested Development season 1](#)

George Bluth Sr., patriarch of the wealthy Bluth family, is the founder and former CEO of the successful Bluth Company which markets and builds [mini-mansions](#) among many other activities. His son [Michael](#) serves as manager of the company, and, after being passed over for a promotion, decides to leave both the company and his family. Just as he makes this decision, however, George Sr. is arrested by the [Securities and Exchange Commission](#) for defrauding investors and gross spending of the company's money for "[personal expenses](#)". His wife [Lucille](#) becomes CEO, and immediately names as the new [president](#) her extremely sheltered youngest son [Buster](#), who proves ill-equipped, as his only experience with business is a class he took concerning 18th century agrarian business. Furious at being passed over again, Michael

secures another job with a rival company and plans on leaving his family behind for good. Realizing that they need Michael, the family asks him to come back and run the company, which Michael scoffs at until he sees how much the family means to his teenaged son George Michael. To keep the family together, Michael asks his self-centered twin sister Lindsay, her husband Tobias and their daughter Maeby to live together in the Bluth [model home](#) with him and George Michael.^[71]

Throughout the first season, different characters struggle to change their identities. Buster works to escape from his mother's control by bonding with brothers Michael and Gob as well as with love interest Lucille Austero, Lucille Bluth's neighbor and chief social rival.^[72] [George Michael](#) nurses a forbidden crush on his cousin [Maeby](#), while continually trying to meet his father's expectations. Lindsay's husband [Tobias](#) searches for work as an actor, with the aid of [Carl Weathers](#).^[73] Michael falls in love with his screw-up older brother [Gob](#)'s neglected girlfriend [Marta](#), and is torn between being with her and putting "family first".^[73] After seeing Michael physically fight with Gob, Marta realizes that they do not share the same family values and she leaves them both.^[74] To spite Buster, Lucille [adopts a Korean](#) son whom she calls "Annyong" after she mistakes the Korean word for "hello" as his name.^[74] Through an escalating series of dares, Gob marries a woman he just met, played by Will Arnett's then real-life wife [Amy Poehler](#), but cannot get an [annulment](#) because he refuses to admit that he did not consummate the marriage.^[75] [Kitty](#), George Sr.'s former assistant and mistress, tries to [blackmail](#) the company. She is caught in the Bluth family [yacht](#)'s explosion, as used in one of Gob's magic acts, but survives with a cooler full of damning evidence labeled "[H Maddas](#)".^[76] After previous failed attempts, and a brief religious stint in Judaism, George Sr. finally escapes from prison by faking a heart attack. It is also revealed that George Sr. committed "light [treason](#)" by using the company to build mini-palaces for [Saddam Hussein](#) in Iraq.^[77]

Season 2 (2004–05) [\[edit \]](#)

Main article: [Arrested Development season 2](#)

Because of his father's latest prison break deception (a faked heart attack), Michael decides to leave his family and move to [Phoenix, Arizona](#) with George Michael but discovers that he cannot leave the state due to the Bluth Company being under investigation and him having to go to jail as a replacement for his father. Lucille appoints Gob the new Bluth Company president, but since Gob proves utterly incompetent, the position's real duties revert to Michael. During the rest of the season Gob serves as figurehead president; Michael is still under scrutiny for George Sr.'s illegal activity.^[78]

George Sr. is not, in fact, gone. After faking his death in [Mexico](#) by paying off the cops, George Sr. returns to the family model home, where George Michael discovers him hiding in the [attic](#).^[79] To protect his son from legal implications, Michael hides George Sr. in Gob's prop Aztec Tomb, orchestrates a diversion, and tells the family that George Sr. has escaped once more. Throughout the rest of the season, Michael sneaks George Sr. provisions, and George Sr. keeps tabs on the Bluth family through the ventilation system. George Sr. also faces an onslaught from the outside world; the press begins looking for him in [Iraq](#), fumigators surround the house while he's still in the attic, and Kitty returns to steal a sample of his [semen](#) to make her own Bluth baby.

Buster meanwhile joins the army, but escapes serving in Iraq when his hand is bitten off by a loose [seal](#) (a play on "Lucille") Gob had mistakenly trained to develop a taste for mammal flesh. Buster is refitted with a sharp [hook](#), which he copes with poorly and often brandishes dangerously in social situations.^[80] During Buster's long psychological recovery, he bonds with George Sr.'s stoner twin brother Oscar, who moves in with Lucille in an attempt to rekindle a past love affair. Uncle Oscar slowly reveals himself as Buster's presumptive biological father. Eventually, George Sr. takes revenge on the adulterous Oscar and Lucille by kidnapping Oscar, knocking him unconscious, exchanging appearances with him, and sending him to prison in his place.^[81]

Lindsay and Tobias continue their disastrous open relationship. Lindsay tries—but fails—to secure a lover, while Tobias paints himself blue each night in a futile attempt to join the [Blue Man Group](#).^[82] When Lindsay kicks him out of the house, Tobias disguises himself as a singing British nanny named "Mrs. Featherbottom" (an idea he gets from the film *Mrs. Doubtfire*) so he can watch over his daughter Maeby. The family sees right through this incompetent disguise, but they humor Tobias since—in the guise of Mrs. Featherbottom—he does their chores.^[83]

George Michael begins dating a deeply religious girl, [Ann Veal](#), who encourages him to smash pop music CDs and to run for student body president against perennial favorite [Steve Holt](#). Michael dislikes her and tries to disrupt the kids' relationship, most notably by breaking up Ann and George Michael's pre-engagement.^[84] Meanwhile, [Maeby](#) cons her way into an after school job as a film studio executive. When Maeby's studio remakes "Les Cousins Dangereux", George Michael abandons Ann to pursue his crush on Maeby. Maeby herself realises she has feelings for George Michael in light of his relationship, and the two kiss while the living room of the model home collapses.^[81]

Season 3 (2005–06) [[edit](#)]

Main article: [Arrested Development season 3](#)

Michael again searches for his runaway father, George Sr. Gob receives an invitation to a father/son reunion outing, and believes it to be George Sr. trying to contact him. In reality, the invitation was meant to reunite Gob with Steve Holt, son of Eve Holt, a girl Gob slept with in high school. Meanwhile, George Michael and Maeby deal with their previous kiss by avoiding each other.^[85]

In an attempt to remain in disguise, George Sr. joins the [Blue Man Group](#). Michael discovers this and arranges to have his father placed under [house arrest](#).^[86] George Sr. claims that he was set up by an underground British group. Michael goes to Wee Britain, a fictional British-themed city district, to investigate, and in the process meets a new love interest, [Rita Leeds](#) ([Charlize Theron](#)). Michael and the audience are led to believe that Rita is a mole for the underground British group, working for a man named "Mr. F".^[87] However, love-struck Michael proposes to her, and the couple run off to wed. Finally, it is revealed that Rita is actually an "MRF", or "mentally retarded female". Despite Rita's "condition", the family pushes him to go forward with the marriage because Rita is wealthy and they want her money. Michael is not persuaded and gently ends the relationship just as he and Rita are about to walk down the aisle.^[88] Meanwhile, Tobias and Lindsay seek legal help from [Bob Loblaw](#) ([Scott Baio](#)) concerning their troubled marriage.

With the family's retainer used up because of Lindsay's and Tobias's advances, Bob Loblaw chooses to no longer represent the Bluth family. Attorney Jan Eagleman offers to represent the family, on the condition that they participate in a mock trial in a new reality courtroom show called "Mock Trial with [J. Reinhold](#)". Musical accompaniment for the show's theme song and perceived jokes from testifying witnesses is provided by "[William Hung](#) And His Hung Jury". Michael uses an illegal threat from prosecutor [Wayne Jarvis](#) to have the mock case "dismissed". Gob and Franklin briefly appear in another courtroom show presided over by [Bud Cort](#). Meanwhile, Maeby and George Michael perform a mock wedding for Alzheimer's patients that is accidentally conducted by a real priest; the two become legally married.^[89]

The family members are afraid to testify at the mock trial and at the real deposition; Buster fakes a coma, Lindsay and Lucille fake entering rehab, and Gob flees the country to perform in a [USO Tour](#) in Iraq. The deceptions are all uncovered by the prosecution, and in Iraq Gob is arrested for inadvertently inciting an anti-US riot. Buster and Michael travel to Iraq to rescue Gob, and while there, uncover evidence that the mini-palaces George Sr. built in Iraq were actually ordered and paid for by the CIA for wiretapping purposes. After this discovery, the US government drops all of the charges against George Sr. In the general confusion, everyone except George Michael forgets Maeby's sixteenth birthday.^[90]

To celebrate their victory in Iraq, the Bluths throw a shareholders' party on the [RMS Queen Mary](#). During preparation for the party, it is revealed that Lindsay was adopted, meaning that George Michael and Maeby are not blood relatives. At the party, the Bluth's other adopted child, Annyong, reappears. He reveals that he is there to avenge the Bluth family's theft of his grandfather's frozen banana idea and the cause of his subsequent deportation, an event orchestrated many years earlier by Lucille Bluth. Annyong has turned over evidence implicating Lucille in the Bluth Company's accounting scandals. Before the police arrive, Michael and George Michael flee on Gob's yacht, *The C-Word*, and depart to Cabo with half a million dollars in cashier's checks, finally leaving the family to fend for themselves. However, it is revealed in the epilogue that George Sr. is also on the yacht, having lured his brother Oscar into taking his place once again. Also in the epilogue, Maeby tries to sell the television rights to the story of the Bluth family to Ron Howard, who tells her that he sees it as a movie rather than a series.^[91]

Season 4 (2013) [\[edit \]](#)

Main article: [Arrested Development season 4](#)

Filming for a fourth season to be released on Netflix began on August 7, 2012, more than six years after the series had been canceled by Fox.^[37] The season consists of 15 new episodes,^[13] all debuting at the same time on [Netflix](#) on May 26, 2013, in the United States, Canada, the United Kingdom, Ireland, Latin America, and the Nordic countries.^[92] Several actors who had recurring roles in the original series returned to reprise their roles, including [Carl Weathers](#) as himself, [Henry Winkler](#) as Barry Zuckerkorn, [Ben Stiller](#) as Tony Wonder, [Mae Whitman](#) as Ann Veal, [Scott Baio](#) as Bob Loblaw, [Judy Greer](#) as Kitty Sanchez, and [Liza Minnelli](#) as Lucille Austero; while new characters are played by [Debra Mooney](#), [John Slattery](#), [Tommy Tune](#), [Terry Crews](#), [Isla Fisher](#) and [John Krasinski](#).^{[93][94][95][96][97][98]} [Kristen Wiig](#) and [Seth Rogen](#) appear as Lucille and George Sr., respectively, in flashbacks.

All episodes of the season occur over approximately the same stretch of time, but each focuses on a different character. Information on events depicted in a given episode is often partial and filled in during a later episode.^[99]

Creator [Mitch Hurwitz](#) created a recut of season four called *Arrested Development Season 4 Remix: Fateful Consequences*, in which the season's story is presented in chronological order. The recut consists of 22 episodes and was released May 3, 2018, on Netflix.^[100]

Season 5 (2018–19) [[edit](#)]

Main article: [Arrested Development season 5](#)

The fifth season revolves around the mystery of who killed Lucille Austero with the lead suspect being Buster.

Netflix confirmed on May 17, 2017, that a fifth season featuring the full cast had been ordered.^[101] The fifth season includes 16 episodes; the first eight were released on May 29, 2018, and the remaining eight episodes premiered on March 15, 2019.^{[102][103][104]}

Reception [[edit](#)]

Television ratings [[edit](#)]

The show, while critically acclaimed, did not gain a sizable audience.^[5] According to the [Nielsen ratings](#) system, the show's first season was the 120th most popular show among households and the 88th among viewers aged 18 to 49, averaging 6.2 million viewers.^[105]

U.S. ratings in the second season averaged about six million viewers, while the third season averaged about four million viewers.^[106] Fox announced that it would halt the production of the second season at eighteen episodes—four episodes short of the planned season.^[107]

For the third season, Fox positioned the show on Mondays at 8:00 p.m. ET.^[108] Ratings dropped further than previous seasons.^[109] On November 9, 2005, Fox announced that the show would not be airing in November sweeps, and that they had cut the episode order for the third season from 22 to 13.^[109] Fox ended up showing the last four episodes in a two-hour timeslot—directly opposite the opening ceremonies of the [2006 Winter Olympics](#).^[110] The series finale episode received 3.43 million viewers.^[111]

Critical response [[edit](#)]

Original run [[edit](#)]

Throughout its original run, *Arrested Development* received critical acclaim.^[5] It is widely regarded as one of the defining shows of the 2000s and has been praised by many critics as one of the greatest comedies of all time.^{[112][113]} In 2007, the show was listed as one of *Time* magazine's "100 Best TV Shows of All-Time".^[7]

Tim Stack of *Entertainment Weekly* praised the series, saying "Is it beating a dead horse to once again state that this underappreciated gem is the best sitcom on TV? Too bad. *Arrested Development* is the best sitcom on TV!"^[114]

David Bianculli from the *New York Daily News* stated "If you're not watching this series on Fox, the least you can do is buy it on DVD. You'll love it, and it's such a dense show (in the best sense of the word) that it rewards repeated viewing. Like *Scrubs* and the British version of *The Office*, it is the sort of show that truly deserves to be seen uninterrupted, several episodes at a time, for maximum enjoyment. The laughs-per-minute quotient here is insanely high, making it great value as a home library purchase."^[115]

Alison Powell of *The Guardian* said "As Hollywood agents worry about the demise of the town's lowing cash cow, the multi-camera, staged sitcom, here to save the day is *Arrested Development*, a farce of such blazing wit and originality, that it must surely usher in a new era in comedy."^[116]

Gillian Flynn of *Entertainment Weekly* named *Arrested Development* the best television show of 2005 and said in her review that "As oddball as *Arrested* is, it's also humane. A flawless cast—from Will Arnett's breathy, bombastic Gob to Jessica Walter's boozy Lucille—grounds it, aided by Ron Howard's affable narration. The center of sensibility is good son Michael (Jason Bateman) and his even better son, George Michael (Michael Cera). Bateman and Cera give the best reacts around—the former all weary exasperation, the latter adorably bunny-stunned. Together, they're the sweetest, awkwardest straight men on the smartest, most shockingly funny series on TV ... which is likely canceled, despite six Emmy wins. It's a perversion not even the Bluths deserve."^[117] In 2012, *Entertainment Weekly* listed the show at No. 2 in the "25 Best Cult TV Shows from the Past 25 Years", praising its "fast, delirious, interlocking jokes that don't pander to the masses; winky gags (e.g. fake preview scenes for the following week's episode); and a cast of absurd characters".^[118] In 2013, the *Writers Guild of America* ranked it No. 16 on their list of the 101 Best Written TV Series.^[10]

The original run was noted for its satire of the *George W. Bush administration* and the *Iraq war*.^{[119][120]} *Mother Jones* argued "the series delivered what was arguably the sharpest satire of the Bush era and the Iraq War that has been broadcast on television."^[121]

Revival [[edit](#)]

The 2018–2019 revival of the show met with critical disappointment.^{[122][123][124]}

Accolades [[edit](#)]

Main article: [List of awards and nominations received by Arrested Development](#)

In 2004, the first season received seven *Emmy Award* nominations with five wins. It won for Outstanding Comedy Series, Outstanding Directing for a Comedy Series, Outstanding Casting for a Comedy Series, Outstanding Single-Camera Picture Editing for a Comedy Series and Outstanding Writing for a Comedy Series, for the *pilot* episode written by *Mitchell Hurwitz* and directed by brothers *Anthony and Joe Russo*. Jeffrey Tambor was nominated that year for Outstanding Supporting Actor in a Comedy Series.^[125]

In 2005, the second season received eleven Emmy nominations in seven categories with one win. Notable nominations included Outstanding Comedy Series, Outstanding Lead Actor in a Comedy Series (Jason Bateman), Outstanding Supporting Actor in a Comedy Series (Jeffrey Tambor), Outstanding Supporting Actress in a Comedy Series (Jessica Walter) as well as three nominations for Outstanding Writing for a Comedy Series, in which it won for "[Righteous Brothers](#)", written by Mitchell Hurwitz and [Jim Vallely](#).^[125]

In 2006, the third season received four Emmy nominations, for Outstanding Comedy Series, Outstanding Supporting Actor in a Comedy Series (Will Arnett), Outstanding Single-Camera Picture Editing for a Comedy Series and Outstanding Writing for a Comedy Series for the series finale "[Development Arrested](#)".^[125]

In 2013, the fourth season received three Emmy nominations, for Outstanding Actor in a Comedy Series (Jason Bateman), Outstanding Music Composition for a Series (Original Dramatic Score) and Outstanding Single-camera Picture Editing for a Comedy Series.^[125]

Other awards include:

- The 2004 [TV Land Award](#) for "Future Classic", the first recognition the series received. The award presentation is included on the season one DVD release.^[126]
- The 2004 [Television Critics Association](#) Awards for Outstanding Comedy and Outstanding New Program, and the 2005 award for Outstanding Achievement in Comedy.^{[127][128]}
- The 2005 [Golden Globe Award](#) for Best Performance by an Actor in a Television Series – Musical or Comedy for Jason Bateman.^[129]
- The 2004 [Writers Guild of America Award](#) for Episodic Comedy, for the episode "[Pier Pressure](#)", written by Mitchell Hurwitz and Jim Vallely.^[130]
- The 2004 [Satellite Award](#) for Best Television Series – Comedy or Musical, along with Jeffrey Tambor and Jessica Walter for Best Performance by an Actor and Actress in a Supporting Role in a Series – Comedy or Musical.^[131] In 2005, Jason Bateman and Portia de Rossi won for Best Actor and Actress in a Series – Comedy or Musical.^[132] Jason Bateman also won the same award the following ceremony.^[133]
- The 2005 [Young Artist Award](#) for Best Performance in a TV Series (Comedy or Drama) – Supporting Young Actress for Alia Shawkat.^[134]

Controversies [[edit](#)]

Lawsuit [[edit](#)]

In November 2003, the producers of the show were sued by the hip hop group [Arrested Development](#) over the alleged use of their name.^[135] Rapper [Speech](#) from the group said "The use of our name by Fox is not only confusing to the public, but also has the potential to significantly dilute what the 'Arrested Development' name means to our fans".^[135] The lawsuit was settled for an undisclosed sum.^[135] This incident was alluded to in the episode "[Motherboy XXX](#)". The narrator claims the show is "legally required to make a distinction" between the "Motherboy" event happening in the episode and a band called "Motherboy".^[135]

Tambor's misconduct [[edit](#)]

In an interview with *The Hollywood Reporter* in May 2018, Tambor apologized for actions that led to sexual misconduct accusations against him by co-workers on the TV show *Transparent*,^[136] and mentioned one "blowup" he had with co-star Jessica Walter during production of *Arrested Development*.^[137] Walter was asked about the incident during a cast interview with *The New York Times*. She became emotional, stating that "in almost 60 years of working, I've never had anybody yell at me like that on a set and it's hard to deal with, but I'm over it now ... [Tambor] never crossed the line on our show, with any, you know, sexual whatever. Verbally, yes, he harassed me, but he did apologize. I have to let it go."^[19]

Bateman stated that "in the entertainment industry it is incredibly common to have people who are, in quotes, 'difficult' ... [acting] is a weird thing, and it is a breeding ground for atypical behavior and certain people have certain processes." Tony Hale said that "we all have bad moments", while David Cross suggested that Tambor's outbursts were a "cumulative effect". *The Daily Beast* criticized Cross's comment as suggesting that Walter had "asked for it."^[138] Shawkat came to Walter's defense, saying that being difficult "doesn't mean it's acceptable" to treat someone badly.^[19] After outlets criticized the men's statements, Hale, Bateman, and Cross issued apologies to Walter.^{[139][140][141]} Netflix cancelled the show's UK press tour. Cera, who was not part of the group interview, stated that "obviously I have to give a lot of consideration to whether I take jobs with anyone and think about how it affects people."^[142]

Notes [[edit](#)]

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- a. [^] Sum of the [original season 4 release](#) and [season 4 remix](#).

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External links [edit]

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Episodes	Season 1	"Pilot" · "Top Banana" · "Bringing Up Buster" · "Key Decisions" · "Visiting Ours" · "Charity Drive" · "My Mother, the Car" · "In God We Trust" · "Storming the Castle" · "Pier Pressure" · "Public Relations" · "Marta Complex" · "Beef Consommé" · "Shock and Aww" · "Staff Infection" · "Missing Kitty" · "Altar Egos" · "Justice Is Blind" · "Best Man for the Gob" · "Whistler's Mother" · "Not Without My Daughter" · "Let 'Em Eat Cake"	
	Season 2	"The One Where Michael Leaves" · "The One Where They Build a House" · "¡Amigos!" · "Good Grief" · "Sad Sack" · "Afternoon Delight" · "Switch Hitter" · "Queen for a Day" · "Burning Love" · "Ready, Aim, Marry Me!" · "Out on a Limb" · "Hand to God" · "Motherboy XXX" · "The Immaculate Election" · "Sword of Destiny" · "Meat the Veals" · "Spring Breakout" · "Righteous Brothers"	
	Season 3	"The Cabin Show" · "For British Eyes Only" · "Forget-Me-Now" · "Notapusy" · "Mr. F" · "The Ocean Walker" · "Prison Break-In" · "Making a Stand" · "S.O.B.s" · "Fakin' It" · "Family Ties" · "Exit Strategy" · "Development Arrested"	
	Season 4	"Flight of the Phoenix" · "Borderline Personalities" · "Indian Takers" · "The B. Team" · "A New Start" · "Double Crossers" · "Colony Collapse" · "Red Hairing"	
	Season 5		
Characters	Primary characters	Michael Bluth · Fünke family	

Awards for *Arrested Development*
[show]

V · T · E
Netflix original continuation series
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Current
Black Mirror (2016–present) · *Inside the World's Toughest Prisons* (2018–present) · *Skam Italia* (2020–present) · *Unsolved Mysteries* (2020–present) · *Blown Away* (2021–present) · *Kota Factory* (2021–present) · *The Mole* (2022–present) · *From Me to You: Kimi ni Todoke* (2024–present) · *Temptation Island* (2025–present) · *Weak Hero* (2025–present) · *Everyone is Doing Great* (2026–present) · *Pop Culture Jeopardy!* (2026–present)

Former
Arrested Development (2013–19) · *Star Wars: The Clone Wars* (2014) · *Trailer Park Boys* (2014–18) · *The Killing* (2014) · *Dragons* (2015–18) · *Longmire* (2015–17) · *Justin Time* (2016) · *Lovesick* (2016–18) · *Midnight Diner* (2016–19) · *EastSiders* (2017–19) · *Glitch* (2017–19) · *Mystery Science Theater 3000* (2017–18) · *Slasher* (2017–19) · *Comedians in Cars Getting Coffee* (2018–19) · *Hip-Hop Evolution* (2018–20) · *Little Things* (2018–21) · *MeatEater* (2018–22) · *Paquita Salas* (2018–19) · *The Last Kingdom* (2018–22) · *The Staircase* (2018) · *Travelers* (2018) · *Designated Survivor* (2019) · *QB1: Beyond the Lights* (2019) · *The Mafia Dolls* (2019) · *Top Boy* (2019–23) · *Zumbo's Just Desserts* (2019) · *Lucifer* (2019–21) · *Money Heist* (2019–2021) · *You* (2019–2025) · *Shaun the Sheep* (2020) · *Cobra Kai* (2021–2025) · *Girl from Nowhere* (2021) · *Sexy Beasts* (2021) · *Takki* (2021) · *The A List* (2021) · *The Mire* (2021–2024) · *Bee and PuppyCat* (2022) · *Borgen* (2022) · *El Marginal* (2022) · *Manifest* (2022–23) · *Power Rangers* (2022–23) · *Tiger & Bunny* (2022) · *Star Trek: Prodigy* (2024) · *Girls5eva* (2024)

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2010s American single-camera sitcoms
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2000s American black comedy television series
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2010s American black comedy television series
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Television shows about alcohol abuse
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Television series about cousins
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